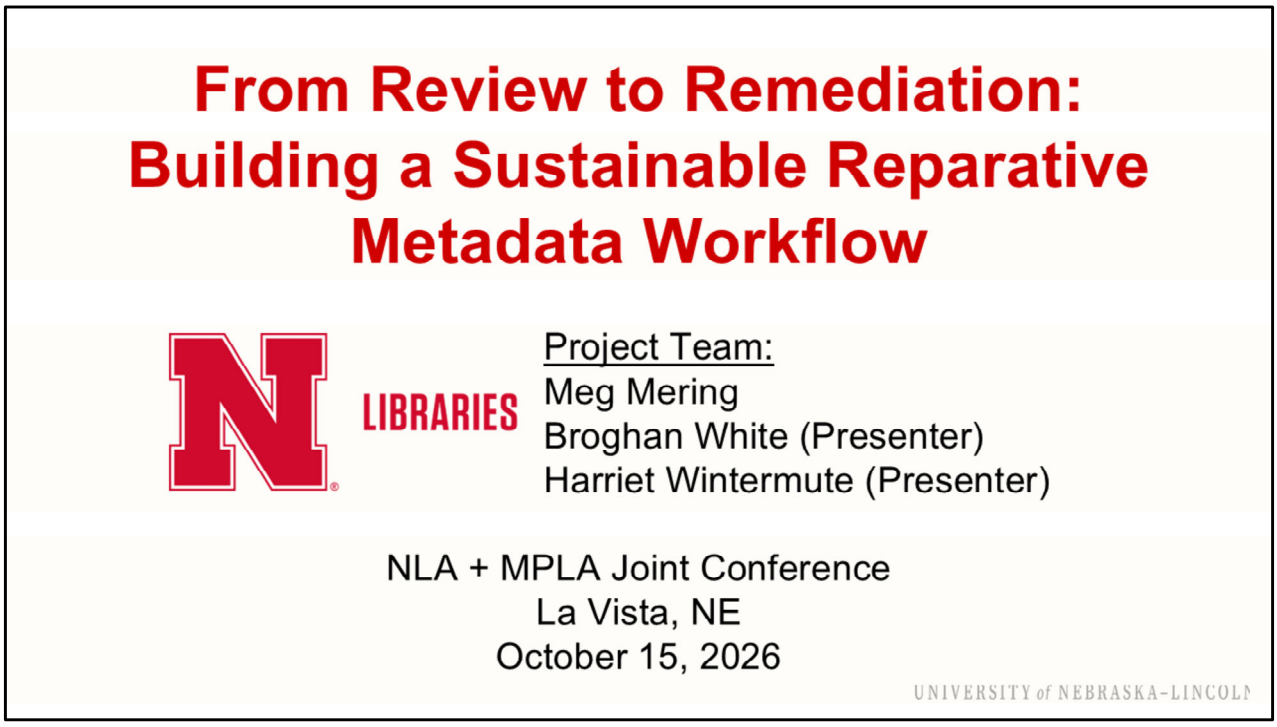



HW

Hello! Welcome to our session READ SLIDE TITLE today at NLA MPLA. We appreciate you coming to learn about our work at UNL Libraries.

My name is Harriet Wintermute. I am the department chair for ACME which stands for Acquisitions, Cataloging, Metadata, and E-Resources at the University of Nebraska-Lincoln Libraries. Presenting with me today is Broghan White, Cataloging & Metadata Librarian. Our project team also included Meg Mering, Metadata Librarian.

# Pilot

**April 2025 to August 2026**

Library of Congress Subject Headings:

- Illegal immigration
- Problem children
- Sexual minorities
- McKinley, Mount (Alaska)
- America, Gulf of



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HW

- We undertook a pilot project
- Spent over a year on this project, starting in April 2025 and last headings completed in August 2026.
- Five LCSH terms were selected for the pilot:
  - READ EACH HEADING
- Taking related variants into account – we reviewed and addressed over 100 headings.
- Keep watching….we'll reveal the changes for these five terms.

## Goal

**Develop practices to replace or supplement pejorative or outdated terms in our metadata**

Engage stakeholders early and often
Build sustainable, documented processes
Leverage native Alma and Primo tools
Apply changes consortium-wide
Design every change to be reversible



Positive thinking free icon created by Magnific - Flaticon

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HW

- Project charge was to review, test and implement practices to replace or supplement pejorative or outdated terms in our metadata
- We approached this work intentionally
    - Included stakeholder communication and feedback channels
        - as often as possible,
        - and before moving forward with changes
    - The work needed to be sustainable, easily manageable, and documented for future use
    - Supporting that sustainability meant we wanted to use native tools already available to ExLibris Alma and Primo programmatically
    - We are in an Alma Network Zone environment and
        - we wanted to support our consortium members in the NU system (UNO UNK UNMC UNL Law)
        - by rolling out the changes in the network zone
            - Not just in our Institution Zone
        - Tat way most of the changes would benefit everyone with the least effort

- Lastly, another requirement towards sustainability
    - Any changes we would make needed to be reversible
    - The Library of Congress might update their headings to ones we wanted to use again soeday
    - Also language and preferences change over time, so even a currently respectful term might need upating in a few years.




HW

- Not new work - library workers have challenged biased LCSH language for decades
  - Sanford Berman in 1971 published Prejudices and Antipathies
  - Other librarians in the literature pointed out problems, including gender, LGBTQ+ terminology, and more
  - National attention with the “Change the Subject” documentary spotlights
    - Student activism at Dartmouth, 2019 regarding the previous "Illegal aliens" LCSH
  - Subject Analysis Committee, under the ALA divisions ALCTS now CORE report on "Illegal aliens,"
  - Cataloging Lab's Problem LCSH list, a community source for replacement terms
  - Library of Congress now working on multi-year project to update “Indians” headings
- Two peer library projects we examined closely for inspiration
  - University of Toronto used two part approach

    - First -- "mask" certain LCSH with more appropriate terms in the public display, using display normalization rules
    - second -- add local subject headings using uncontrolled to bibliographic records automatically to improve indexing matches.
- WRLC uses blended approaches
    - Local Autority Records
    - Bibliographic normalization rules to enhance records
    - Normalization rules to enhance Community Zone Records with local metadata
    - Primo display normalization (similar to Toronto)
    - DEI Exclude Terms – DOUBLE CHECK THIS
- We learned a lot from WRLC
    - They are also a consortial network zone environment and
    - We were able to borrow

Trigger: EO 14172 (Jan 2025) renamed Denali and Gulf of Mexico; LC quickly proposed changes to ~22 LCSH

Problem: LCSH/LCNAF auto-update in the Alma CZ, so we needed local processes

Pilot ran April 2025 to August 2026 (originally planned for 4 months)

Simple headings first, complex headings (many records, subdivisions) later

Test in IZ first, then implement in the shared UNCL NZ

Result: nearly 100 LCSH reviewed, replaced, or supplemented

Preliminary research (WCRL and UToronto)

Goals: replace/supplement terms, ensure everything is reversable, document everything, establish repeatable workflow

## Research

**Ask...**

What do people call themselves?
What's respectful?
What's current?
What do other libraries use?
Who should we ask?
Replace, supplement, or keep?

**Find...**

Testimonials
Affinity groups
Committee publications
Peer libraries
News and journal articles



Machine learning free icon created by Eucalyp - Flaticon

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HW

- We are all librarians and we love to research, right?
- Researched each term in the pilot because we wanted to identify terms that were neutral language, person-first, or current
    - Search for what people call themselves, what's respectful?
    - If the use case is in a specific field or discipline – what's current terminology?
    - Maybe some other libraries have adopted newer terms – check with them – they might've done the research already.
    - Is there a community we should contact?
    - Dos the term need to be replaced entirely? Should we supplement the records with a variant term? Does our research find that the term is not inherently offensive and fine to keep as is?
- We know how to identify the good / authoritative sources. These could be things like
    - The author/creator's own words (their own blog, webpage, biographical statement, primary sources)
    - A community group such as a campus staff affinity group

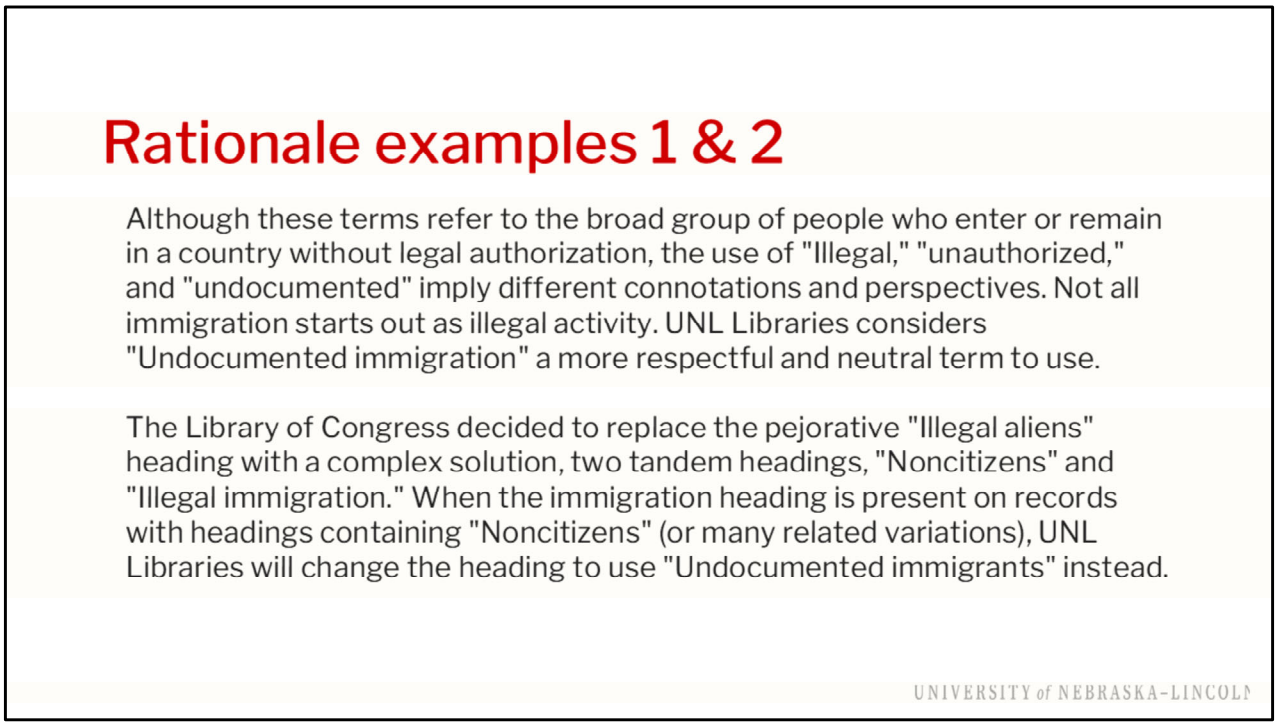
- Professional organization committee reports and related publications
- Newspaper articles and interviews, or professional journal literature




HW

- Once we've learned as much as we can about the term and alternatives, we consider a recommended action
    - Replace: when we can do a direct one-to-one switch out the old term for the new one
    - Conditional – Sometimes there are certain contexts we would like to address – it's not a 1:1 scenario but certain conditions have to be true before changing the term
    - Supplement – In some cases it's apparent we need to keep both the old and new term present in the record to help people find the resources. A good example of this use case are the recent changes to federally designated geographic names - it is helpful to have the newer and less known name on the record at the same time as the common or long used name
    - Retain – Sometimes there are names we can leave alone. This might be based on their use in the field, or because it's the official name of an event.
- We keep a big Excel workbook to track all this information including the

recommendations, rationales, and feedback.

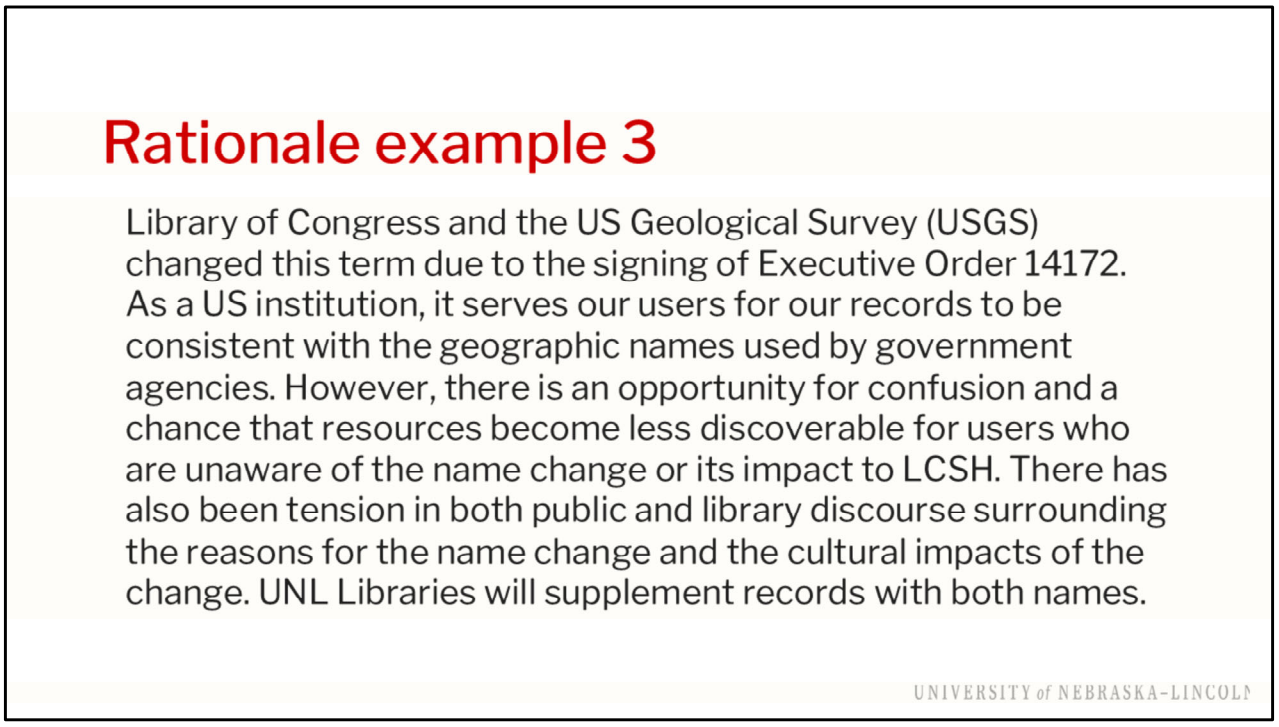



HW

HW

- With research and recommended action completed, we then prepare a rationale to provide an explanation and foundation
    - Reinforces that we are not making these decisions arbitrarily
    - That we have arrived at this decision with care and intention
- We aimed to provide a simple, succinct statement of the facts
    - using neutral language,
    - Centering the person – when applicable
    - Reflecting current usage
    - And grounded our reasons with citations
- There were times we also had to acknowledge tension and complexity (e.g., place names)
- We included these rationales in our tracking workbook and in much of our communication
- Here we have two example rationales we prepared related to the LCSH “Illegal Immigration”

- The first one applies when the term appears on the record on its own – i.e., is not accompanied by the LCSH “Noncitizens”
    - READ FIRST RATIONALE (in case someone cannot see it)
- The second rationale applies when the LCSH “illegal immigration” is accompanied by the LCSH “Noncitizens”
    - Here we have contextual implications – in many other cases, “Noncitizens” itself has nothing inherently bad, but in this specific scenario we wanted to update the term in the records.
    - READ SECOND RATIONALE




HW

- And here's a third rationale we prepared, related to the geographic place names in our pilot --
  - McKinley, Mount (Alaska) …. Denali, Mount (Alaska)
  - America, Gulf of …. Mexico, Gulf of
- READ SLIDE (in case someone cannot see it)
- Here, due to the complexity and tension between federally designated name and cultural or common use, we decided to supplement, our records with the previous term, not replace them.

## Stakeholders

### We asked before we changed

Shared every proposal before implementation
Engaged Libraries staff, groups, and consortium members
Consulted communities and subject experts
Adapted when feedback called for it



Speech Bubble free icon created by Magnific - Flaticon

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HW?

- We reached out to various stakeholder groups for their feedback on our proposed change
- Audiences:
  - Libraries faculty and staff (posts in our internal newsletter called Daily Buzz)
  - Libraries groups related to metadata, Alma, inclusive excellence….
  - Consortium group related to cataloging
- Shared information about the headings and proposed change, along with rationale and resources
- Gave about two weeks for feedback, with a reminder post
- Targeted outreach when needed:
  - Community: UNL Pride Affinity Group (Sexual minorities)
  - Subject expert: educational psychology faculty (Problem children)
  - Peers: BTAA libraries, UToronto, BTAA Heads of Cataloging meeting
- Feedback was largely supportive, and it changed outcomes
  - "Children with behavioral issues" became "problems," for parity with other thesauri [remove if already covered elsewhere]

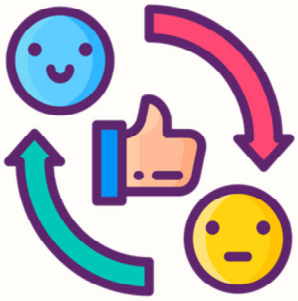
- The place names round drew the most responses!

## Making the change

**At this point:**

- ✓ Identified term needing reparative work
- ✓ Chose replacement/supplemental term
- ✓ Determined an action (replace, supplement, etc.)
- ✓ Gathered feedback from stakeholders

**Choose the technical approach that best suits the desired action. Every approach is easily reversible!**





HW

- Once we've learned as much as we can about the term and alternatives, we consider a recommended action
  - Replace: when we can do a direct one-to-one switch out the old term for the new one
  - Conditional – Sometimes there are certain contexts we would like to address – it's not a 1:1 scenario but certain conditions have to be true before changing the term
  - Supplement – In some cases it's apparent we need to keep both the old and new term present in the record to help people find the resources. A good example of this use case are the recent changes to federally designated geographic names - it is helpful to have the newer and less known name on the record at the same time as the common or long used name
  - Retain – Sometimes there are names we can leave alone. This might be based on their use in the field, or because it's the official name of an event.
- We keep a big Excel workbook to track all this information including the

recommendations, rationales, and feedback.

# Local Authority Records

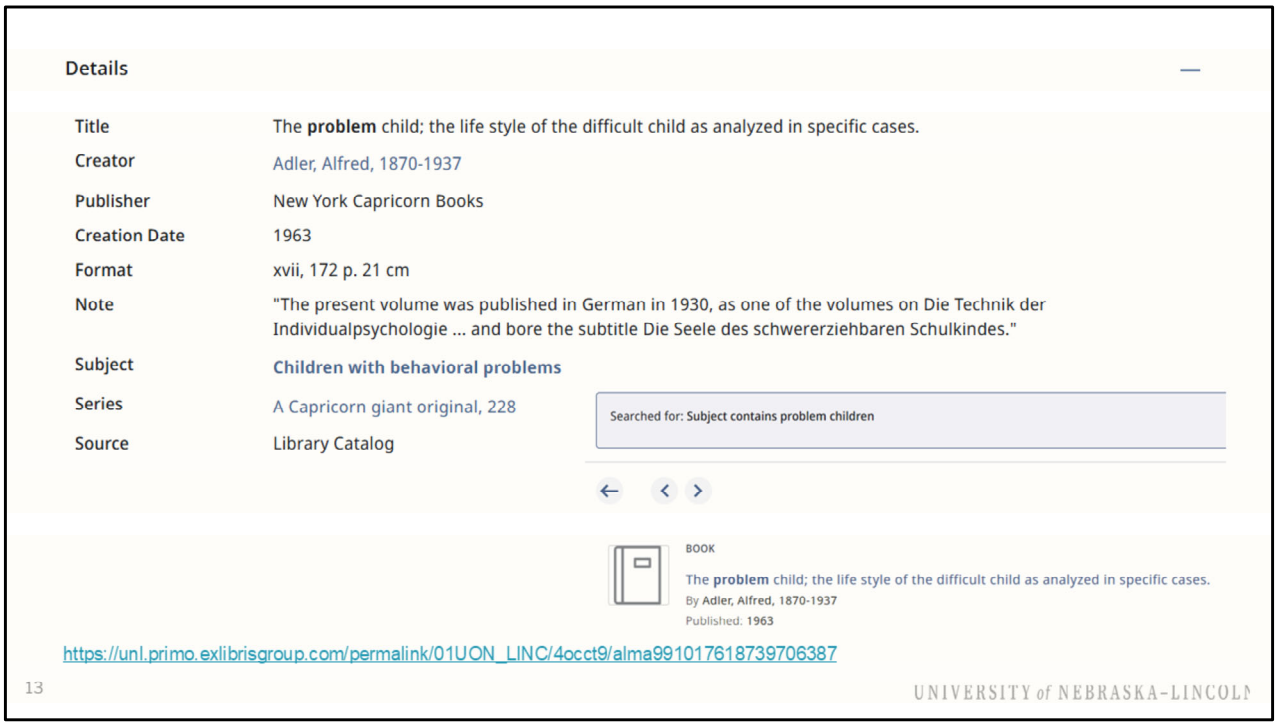
**A quick and simple way to make direct 1:1 changes**

- Derived from existing LCSH records
- Added field to include rationale for the change
- Alma's Preferred Term Correction job automatically changes the subject headings



Authority free icon created by Flat Icons - Flaticon

| | |
|---|---|
| **010** | __ \|a sh 85107104 |
| **035** | __ \|a (DLC) sh 85107104 |
| **035** | __ \|a (LIBRARY_OF_CONGRESS)98170919900000041 |
| **040** | __ \|a DLC \|c DLC \|d DLC \|d ViU |
| **150** | __ \|a Children with behavioral problems |
| **450** | __ \|a Problem children \|5 NbU |
| **450** | __ \|a Difficult children |
| **450** | __ \|a Maladjusted children |
| **550** | __ \|w g \|a Children |
| **550** | __ \|a Behavior disorders in children |
| **667** | __ \|a "Problem children" is a term that was used in educational and psychological literature to describe children with behavior issues due to emotional instability or social environment. The literature has shifted to focus on the behavior rather than the nature of the children, making this term outdated. Current headings found in relevant databases include "behavior problems" and "problem behavior." UNL Libraries considers "Children with behavioral problems" to be a more respectful and neutral term and that it maintains parity with the terminology currently found in the relevant psychological and educational literature databases. |
| **670** | __ \|a Difficult children, there is no such thing, c2003: \|b t.p. introd. (children demonstrating behavioral disorders are being classified as educationally difficult to manage) |
| **680** | __ \|i Here are entered works on children with behavior difficulties due to emotional instability or social environment. |


Details
Title
The problem child; the life style of the difficult child as analyzed in specific cases.
Creator
Adler, Alfred, 1870-1937
Publisher
New York Capricorn Books
Creation Date
1963
Format
xvii, 172 p. 21 cm
Note
"The present volume was published in German in 1930, as one of the volumes on Die Technik der Individualpsychologie ... and bore the subtitle Die Seele des schwererziehbaren Schulkindes."
Subject
Children with behavioral problems
Series
A Capricorn giant original, 228
Source
Library Catalog
Searched for: Subject contains problem children
BOOK
The problem child; the life style of the difficult child as analyzed in specific cases.
By Adler, Alfred, 1870-1937
Published: 1963
https://unl.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01UON_LINC/4occt9/alma991017618739706387
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# Normalization Rules

**Some LCSH have multiple meanings or contexts that make a direct one-to-one change unsuitable.**

- Normalization rules can change context-specific subject headings
- Used for the subject headings "Noncitizens" only when it appeared in records alongside "Illegal immigration"
- Rule is applied quarterly to catch newly added records

```
rule "Change 650.a Noncitizens to 650.a Undocumented immigrants when appearing with 650.a Illegal immigration"
when
   (exists "650.a.Noncitizens*") and (exists "650.a.Undocumented immigration*|Illegal immigration*")
then
   replaceContents "650.a.Noncitizens" with "Undocumented immigrants"
end
```

## Details

| | |
|---|---|
| Title | Alien smuggling : management and operational improvements needed to address growing problem : report to congressional committees |
| Creator | United States. General Accounting Office |
| Publisher | Washington, D.C. P.O. Box 37050, Washington, D.C. 20013 : The Office |
| Creation Date | 2000 |
| Format | 35 p. : ill. ; 28 cm |
| Note | Cover title<br>"May 2000."<br>"GAO/GGD-00-103."<br>"B-283952"--P. 1 |
| Subject | **Undocumented immigrants** -- Government policy -- United States<br>Smuggling -- United States -- Prevention<br>**Undocumented immigration** -- Government policy -- United States<br>**Undocumented immigrants** |
| Genre | Electronic books |
| Source | Library Catalog |

https://unl.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01UON_LINC/4occt9/alma991005416739706387

# Normalization Rules

**In some cases, we deemed it appropriate to supplement LCSH rather than replace them.**

- Normalization rules added our supplemental headings in records that had specific LCSH
- This approach was used for the LCSH "America, Gulf of" and "McKinley, Mount (Alaska)" to support discoverability
- Added subject term in a local subject field (690)

```
rule "Add 690.a.Denali, Mount (Alaska), Gulf of when 651.a.McKinley, Mount (Alaska)*"
when
   (exists "651.a.McKinley, Mount (Alaska)*")
then
   addField "690.a.Denali, Mount (Alaska)" if (not exists "690.a.Denali, Mount (Alaska)*")
   addSubfield "690.5.NbU" if (exists "690.a.Denali, Mount (Alaska)")
   addSubfield "690.9.local" if (exists "690.a.Denali, Mount (Alaska)")
   correctDuplicateSubfields "690" "59"
   correctDuplicateFields "690"
end
```

**Details**

| | |
|---|---|
| **Title** | **The ascent of Denali (Mount McKinley)** : a narrative of the first complete **ascent** of the highest peak in North America |
| **Creator** | Stuck, Hudson, 1863-1920 |
| **Publisher** | Lincoln : University of Nebraska Press |
| **Creation Date** | 1989 |
| **Format** | xix, 188 p., 34 leaves of plates : ill., maps ; 21 cm |
| **Note** | Reprint. Originally published: New York : Scribner, 1914<br>"A Bison book." |
| **Subject** | Stuck, Hudson, 1863-1920 -- Travel -- Alaska -- **McKinley, Mount**<br>Mountaineering -- Alaska -- **McKinley, Mount**<br>**McKinley, Mount** (Alaska)<br>Denali, **Mount** (Alaska) |
| **Source** | Library Catalog |

https://unl.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01UON_LINC/4occt9/alma991011224519706387

# Challenges: Community Zone

**We are unable to change existing metadata in records sourced from the Alma CZ**

- Normalization rules can supplement CZ records with preferred subject headings
- Subjects are added in a local subject field (690)
- LCSH are hidden from display using DEI exclude list in instances of direct 1:1 changes

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | **650** | _0 \|a Gender identity |
| | **650** | _0 \|a Sexual minorities |
| | **650** | _0 \|a Sexual orientation |
| | **690** | __ \|a LGBTQIA2S+ people \|5 NbU \|5 NbU |

## Details

| | |
|---|---|
| Title | **Gender Is Really Strange**. |
| Creator | Goetz, Teddy G., author. |
| Contributor | Standing, Sophie, illustrator. |
| Publisher | London : Jessica Kingsley Publishers |
| Creation Date | 2023 |
| Format | 1 online resource (42 pages)<br>text file rdaft |
| Subject | **Gender** identity<br>Sexual orientation<br>LGBTQIA2S+ people |

# Challenges: CDI Records

**The only tool capable of impacting Central Discovery Index (CDI) records is Alma's DEI exclude list**

- The DEI exclude list can remove and replace subject terms and add annotations to subjects in display
- It is limited in function and is only useful for direct 1:1 changes in CDI records
- Using it will apply to all records, not just CDI

# Results

| LCSH | Repaired subject heading |
|---|---|
| ~~Illegal immigration~~ | Undocumented immigration |
| ~~Problem children~~ | Children with behavioral problems |
| ~~Sexual minorities~~ | LGBTQIA2S+ people |
| McKinley, Mount (Alaska) | Denali, Mount (Alaska) |
| America, Gulf of | Mexico, Gulf of |

# Next Steps & Resources

**Although the pilot project has finished, the work continues.**

- A new group will convene to continue identifying problematic and replacement subject headings
- We are developing a submission form for users to let us know if they find a subject heading in need of reparative work
- We are maintaining a GitHub repository containing our normalization rules and workflows

# Resources


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# Thank you!



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